

Foursquare Identity

Keystones

Overview

The Foursquare Identity Keystones build upon the Foursquare Global Distinctives (Foursquare Identity #1) and articulate key markers of the U.S. Foursquare Church. These keystones were discovered using organization identity methodology by engaging a broad perspective from a large number of U.S. Foursquare credentialed ministers. The keystones that emerged are:

1. **Indigenous Empowerment:** The practice of finding and preparing leaders to lead in their own context: ethnically, culturally, geographically, & locally.
2. **Women in Senior Leadership:** The value and belief that women should be celebrated and equipped for every area of ministry leadership.
3. **Integrated Mission:** The practice of embracing both evangelism and social action/care as one integrated approach to ministry.
4. **Moderation:** The value of taking a “middle of the road” stance in worship and ministry described as, “in the essentials unity, in the non-essentials liberty, and in all things charity.”
5. **Pentecostal Ethos:** The unique ways we live out our embrace of the work and power of the Holy Spirit in and through us.

It is important to note these identity markers, as an ensemble of qualities, combine together to uniquely describe what it means to be Foursquare. These identity markers emerge from the history and practices of the Foursquare Church and build upon existing work on our identity. By embodying and communicating our distinctiveness, we are better equipped to make clear who we are so that we live in congruence, and so others who consider becoming Foursquare know if they are in alignment with our identity and mission.

Each of the five identity keystones are examined further in the Foursquare Identity Keystones booklet. Each summary provides a basis for conversation and further study of these important aspects of Foursquare identity as they relate to the future of the organization and its missional influence in our current cultural context.

Interview Questions

- In your own words, please explain each of the five Identity Keystones of the Foursquare Church.

Pastoral Considerations/Application

- We want ministers who wholeheartedly embody and champion all five of the Identity Keystones in life and practice.